

Donor Retention & Fundraising Performance

Executive Summary | Murmuration Avian Conservancy (Synthetic Portfolio Project)

76,000+	FY21-FY26	3 Tools
Relational records analyzed	Reporting period	Power Query, MySQL, Tableau

Business Objective

Provide nonprofit leadership with a reliable view of donor durability, fundraising growth, acquisition effectiveness, volunteer engagement, campaign results, and solicitation response - while identifying whether source-system coverage distorts year-over-year conclusions.

Approach

Prepared and profiled source files in Excel Power Query; built raw and analysis-ready layers in MySQL; standardized names, contact fields, dates, categories, campaign mappings, and solicitation attribution; validated row preservation and referential integrity; and created Tableau dashboards supported by reusable SQL views.

Key Findings

Finding	Business significance
Stable-source active donors increased from 2,078 in FY22 to 3,377 in FY26.	Participation expanded materially across comparable source coverage.
Retention remained between 63.3% and 68.2%, reaching 68.0% in FY26.	Fundraising growth was supported by recurring donor relationships, not acquisition alone.
Donor-volunteers repeated at 57.9% versus 49.8% for non-volunteers.	Volunteer engagement is a promising stewardship and donor-development pathway.
Stable-source gross giving grew from about \$1.27M in FY21 to \$2.12M in FY26.	Comparable giving increased approximately 67% across the reporting period.
Email produced the highest solicitation response rate at 9.5%.	Email is the strongest scalable channel for response volume in the synthetic dataset.
Annual Fund campaigns achieved 110.7%-157.3% of goal.	Repeated overperformance suggests targets may be conservative.

Material Data-Quality Finding

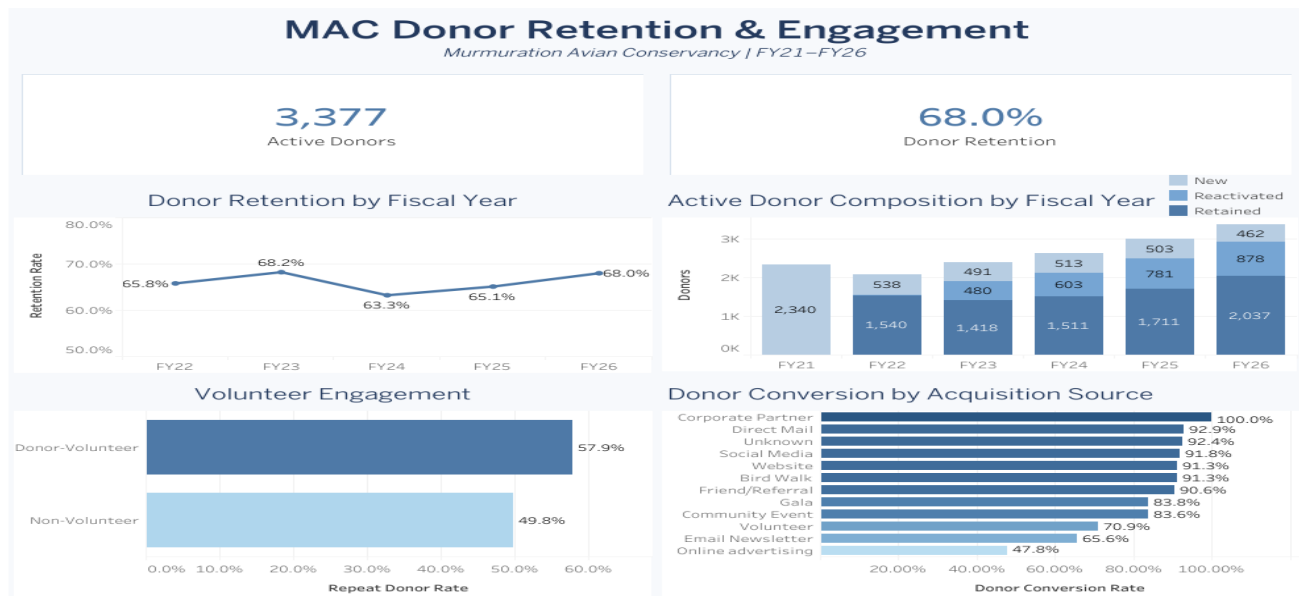
A merged gift source covered only June 2023-June 2025, while the stable source covered FY21-FY26. The incomplete coverage lowered apparent FY25 retention to 44.6%. Rather than delete valid transactions or manufacture missing activity, the analysis preserved both sources, documented the limitation, and used a comparable stable-source cohort. Stable-source FY25 retention was 65.1%.

Recommended Actions

1	Prioritize volunteer-to-donor stewardship Design targeted journeys for volunteers because they demonstrate stronger repeat giving.
2	Use channel-specific solicitation strategies Use Email for scalable response volume and Event or Mail selectively for higher-value outreach.
3	Investigate low-converting acquisition Review Online Advertising audience, creative, landing experience, and attribution before increasing spend.
4	Recalibrate Annual Fund targets Use historical performance and capacity assumptions to establish more decision-useful goals.
5	Monitor source coverage Add automated completeness checks during CRM migrations, file merges, and vendor-feed integrations.

Dashboard Outputs

Donor Retention & Engagement



Fundraising & Campaign Performance

MAC Fundraising & Campaign Performance

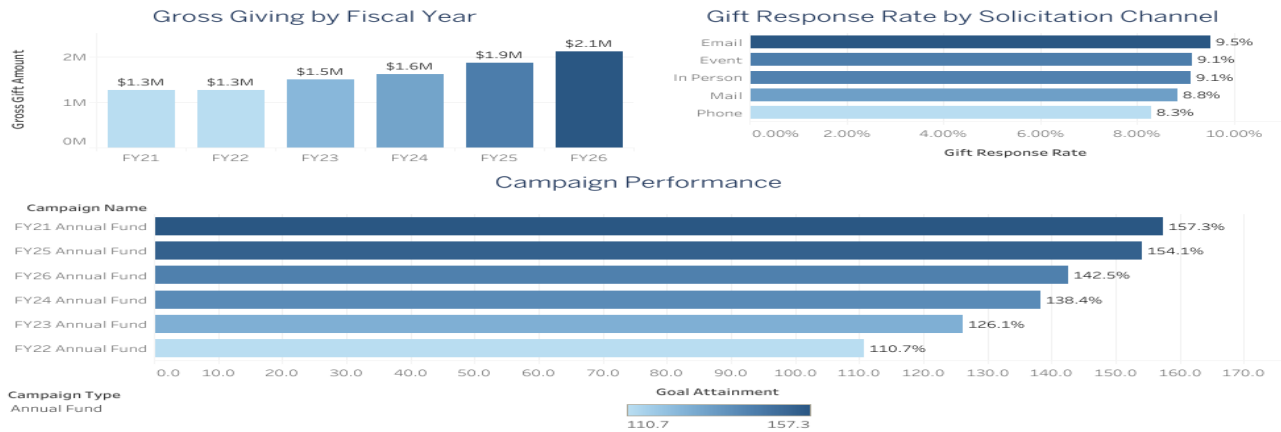
Murmuration Avian Conservancy | FY21–FY26

\$10.07M

All-Source Net Giving

9.1%

Solicitation Response



Limitations

This project uses synthetic data. The source-coverage difference requires stable-source cohorts for comparable trends. Regenerated synthetic solicitation timing supports relational consistency but must not be interpreted as evidence of optimal real-world outreach timing.